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YOUR BEST NEXT HIRE IS AI

BUILD SMARTER. SCALE FASTER.

THE FIELD GUIDE

A plain-English playbook for using AI to grow your business — what to hand off first, how to start in a week, and the prompts that actually move the needle. No hype. No code required.



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HOW TO USE AI TO GROW YOUR BUSINESS

START HERE / THE SHIFT

STOP USING AI LIKE A SEARCH BOX

Most people open an AI tool, ask one question, get a so-so answer, and decide it's overhyped. The owners who win do something different: they stop treating AI like a gadget and start treating it like a **team member they manage**.

Think about how you'd onboard a sharp new hire. You wouldn't hand them one vague task and judge them on it. You'd explain the business, show examples of good work, give clear instructions, and review what comes back. AI responds to exactly the same approach — and it works for the cost of a streaming subscription, around the clock, without burning out.

That reframe is the whole game. Once you see AI as a capable assistant rather than a magic answer machine, the question changes from “**what can it do?**” to the far more useful “**what should I delegate?**”

THE 3-PART RULE FOR GREAT RESULTS

Context — tell it who you are, who the customer is, and what good looks like. **Task** — be specific about the exact output you want and its format. **Example** — paste one sample of the tone or structure you're after. Context plus a clear task plus one example beats a clever one-liner almost every time.



FIVE ROLES TO HIRE AI INTO TODAY

You don't need an "AI strategy." You need a short list of jobs that eat your week. Here are the five that pay back fastest for almost any business.

01 THE MARKETING ASSISTANT

Turn one idea into a week of content: draft emails, social posts, blog outlines, and ad copy in your voice. Repurpose a single video or article into ten formats. Best for owners who know they "should post more" but never find the time.

02 THE CUSTOMER SUPPORT REP

Draft replies to common questions, summarize long email threads, and build a polished FAQ from your past tickets. Keeps response times fast and tone consistent — you stay in control by approving before anything sends.

03 THE SALES HELPER

Research a prospect before a call, personalize outreach at scale, draft proposals and follow-ups, and tidy up your notes into next steps the moment a meeting ends. Less admin, more selling.

04 THE OPERATIONS ANALYST

Clean up messy spreadsheets, summarize reports, draft SOPs and checklists, and write the "how we do it here" docs you've been meaning to create for years. Quietly removes friction from the whole team.

05 THE THINKING PARTNER

Pressure-test a decision, brainstorm names and offers, role-play a tough conversation, or get a plain-English second opinion at 11pm. The role most owners underuse — and the one they end up valuing most.



UP AND RUNNING IN SEVEN DAYS

Skip the overwhelm. Pick **one** tool, give it 20 minutes a day, and follow this path. By Friday you'll have a real workflow, not just a login.

1

PICK ONE TASK THAT DRAINS YOU

Choose a single repetitive job — weekly emails, meeting notes, product descriptions. One. Resist the urge to automate everything at once.

2

BRIEF IT LIKE A NEW HIRE

Write a few sentences on your business, your customer, and your tone. Save this — you'll reuse it at the top of every request.

3

RUN IT, THEN COACH IT

Get a first draft. Don't accept it — reply with "make it shorter," "more casual," "add a call to action." The back-and-forth is where the magic happens.

4

SAVE YOUR WINNING PROMPT

When a result nails it, paste that prompt into a notes file. You're building a personal library you can fire off in seconds next time.

5

ADD A SECOND TASK — THEN TEACH SOMEONE

Once one workflow sticks, repeat it for the next. Show one team member how you did it. Adoption beats perfection every single time.

Steal these starter prompts:

EMAIL IN YOUR VOICE

You're my marketing assistant for [business]. Our customers are [who]. Write a friendly email announcing [thing] in 120 words. Tone: warm, confident, no jargon.

MEETING NOTES – ACTIONS

Here are my raw notes from a call. Summarize the key points and list clear next steps with owners. Flag anything that needs a decision from me.



DO IT RIGHT / AVOID THE TRAPS

FIVE MISTAKES THAT WASTE THE WIN

BEING VAGUE

"Write me a post" gets generic mush. Specifics — audience, length, goal, tone — get gold. Treat every request like a mini-brief.

ACCEPTING THE FIRST DRAFT

The first answer is a starting point, not the finish line. The owners who get great output are the ones who keep editing and asking for more.

TRUSTING BLINDLY

AI can sound confident and still be wrong on facts, figures, and names. Verify anything that matters before it goes out the door. You're the editor-in-chief.

OVERSHARING SENSITIVE DATA

Don't paste customer records, passwords, or anything you wouldn't email a contractor. Use good judgment about what goes in.

TRYING TO BOIL THE OCEAN

Automating ten things badly beats nothing — but automating one thing well beats all of it. Start narrow, win, then expand.

A simple way to measure the payoff: **hours saved × your hourly value**. Reclaim five hours a week and you've effectively hired a part-timer — for next to nothing.



YOUR MOVE / THIS WEEK

THE ONE-PAGE QUICK-START CHECKLIST

- ☐ **Pick one draining task** to hand off first.
- ☐ **Write your business brief** — who you are, your customer, your tone.
- ☐ **Run a first draft**, then coach it with 2–3 rounds of feedback.
- ☐ **Save your best prompt** into a personal library.
- ☐ **Verify the facts** before anything goes public.
- ☐ **Add a second workflow** and teach one teammate.
- ☐ **Track hours saved** — that's your ROI, in black and white.

WANT A SHORTCUT?

This guide is the map. If you'd rather have a guide walk the path with you — the right tools for your business, done-with-you workflows, and a live training on putting AI to work — that's exactly what we do.

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